

RAHUL BAJAJ

CHAIRMAN, BAJAJ AUTO

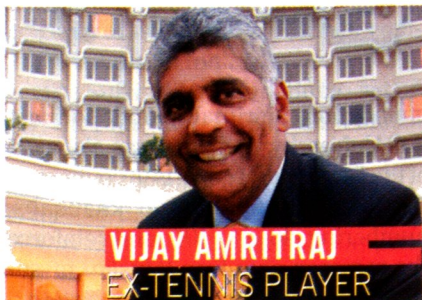
YOU DON'T HAVE TO BE AN INDUSTRIALIST

When I was 16, my father made it very clear that though I was born into a business family, there was no compulsion for me to take on the reins later. It was absolutely fine if I wanted to be a tennis player or a mountaineer. But, he added, I must aim at being the best. If I chose tennis, I should aim at winning at Wimbledon, or if I climbed mountains, I should aim to climb Everest. Even if I wanted to be a cook, he said, there was no harm in it as long as I became a top chef. It was my choice to stay with the family business. But his emphasis on excellence has always inspired me to push boundaries. —As told to Shankkar Aiyar



HEMANT CHAWLA

IN BUSINESS, ALL PARTIES MUST SUCCEED



RAHUL IRANI

VIJAY AMRITRAJ
EX-TENNIS PLAYER

There is no specific advice that made a big difference to my life. My no-nonsense upbringing has much to do with that. However, someone once shared a business philosophy with me that proved to be invaluable—in business, there is no victory unless all parties come away feeling like they have won. I have followed this and my experience now endorses this outlook. I also received some wise advice in the field of money management, when I was advised to always try and save up to 25 per cent of my income. —As told to Sharda Ugra

BORROW WITHIN YOUR MEANS

Early in my career, I was very keen on buying an apartment. That meant taking a substantial loan. But my father advised me to limit the housing loan to eight times my annual income. Salary increments were not included. This would ensure that I repaid the debt in 10-12 years. Since then, I religiously follow these rules and have avoided piling up unnecessary debts. —As told to Shankkar Aiyar



VIMAL BHANDARI
COUNTRY HEAD, AEGON

KNOW THE ROUTE TO SUCCESS

Sometimes, you don't realise the importance of specific advice until many years later. I was studying in Motilal Nehru School of Sports in Haryana. It focused more on extra-curricular activities than on academics. When I was in class VIII, a teacher suggested that I join the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT). From that point, it became my dream to join IIT. Someone who heard about my ambition advised me then to switch schools. He suggested that after I completed class X, I would do well to shift to DPS R.K. Puram in Delhi. I was comfortable in my school, so moving was a difficult decision. But, as it turned out, it was a good move. Had I continued studying there, it would have been extremely difficult to make it to IIT. As things worked out, I graduated from IIT and got a job with Schlumberger. They paid very well and it was while working there that I managed to save enough for the seed capital of Indiabulls. So, as you see, the advice to switch schools had a chain reaction.

—As told to Shankkar Aiyar



SATISH KAUSHIK

RAJIV RATTAN
CO-FOUNDER, INDIABULLS

Excerpted from MoneyToday cover story
"Best financial advice I ever got"

For more such words of wisdom, read
Money Today issue dated January 24

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